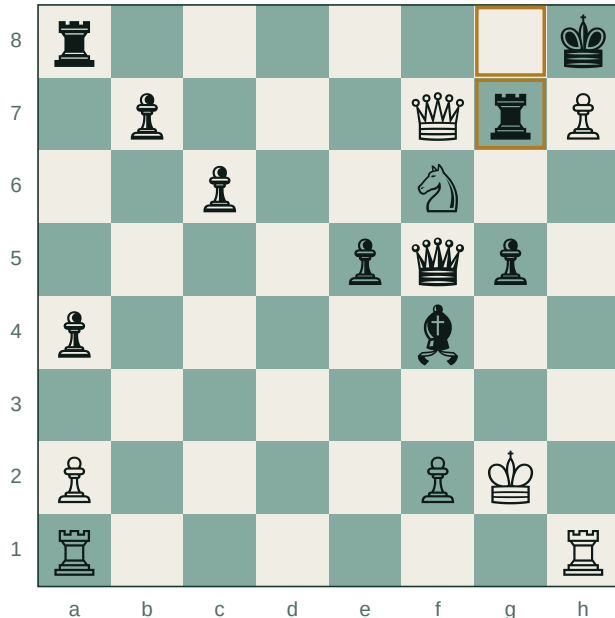


Double checks: White, move 34

Double checks

White to move



Previous move: 33...Rg7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

34. Qg8+ Rgxg8 35. hxg8=Q#

34.Qg8+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From g8 it attacks king on h8, rook on g7 and rook on a8. Recorded reply: **34...Rgxg8**.

35.hxg8=Q# Mate: rook on h1 and queen on g8 give check; Black has no legal reply. The pawn becomes a queen.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on h1 and queen on g8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Double check is forcing, but not necessarily winning. The king may escape to safety if the follow-up is missing.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Double check attacks the king with two pieces at once. The defender must move the king, so an ordinary block or capture of just one checker cannot solve the problem.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the slider that can be uncovered and a checking destination for its blocker. Then calculate the king's legal escapes.

The defending king is on h8. Geometrically undefended: rook on a8 and queen on f5. Check for tactical protection.